



INSTALLATION RELOCATION · YOUR RELOCATION REFERENCE

Eglin AFB Your PCS guide.

Housing, official BAH, moving-day logistics and the first month.

THE CLIENT COLLECTION · SEPTEMBER 2026

Gregg Costin

Practical guidance for your next real estate decision.

(850) 266-5005 · PensacolaMilitaryHousing.com

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THE TWO-MINUTE ORIENTATION

What matters. Where to find it.

THE SHORT ANSWER

Start your Eglin AFB move by confirming the gaining unit, orders, sponsor and housing eligibility. Build the housing budget with the official EGLIN AFB, FL BAH area (FL056), then verify the actual work route, complete ownership costs and your reporting timeline.

- 1

Confirm

Orders, sponsor, reporting location and housing eligibility.
- 2

Compare

Actual work routes and complete housing costs.
- 3

Arrive

Keep documents, cash and your fallback plan ready.

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Use this with your team

Official figures carry sources and dates. Worked examples are hypothetical, not current quotes or promises of approval. Your signed contract, lender requirements, insurance policy and military orders control the actual transaction. Keep private documents in the responsible professional's secure channel.

01

Your installation brief

Begin with the work location and the people responsible for your arrival.



Eglin supports the 96th Test Wing and a broad installation mission. The precise work area matters: a generic route to Eglin AFB can conceal a

substantial difference between gates, work centers and associated locations.

Verified starting points

Item / Detail

Installation Eglin AFB	County Okaloosa County, Florida
BAH planning ZIP / area 32542 / FL056 / EGLIN AFB, FL	Government housing contact Eglin Military Housing Office
Housing office phone 850-882-4533, extension 3	Rate edition 2026 DTMO tables, retrieved September 6, 2026

KEEP IN MIND

The first local question

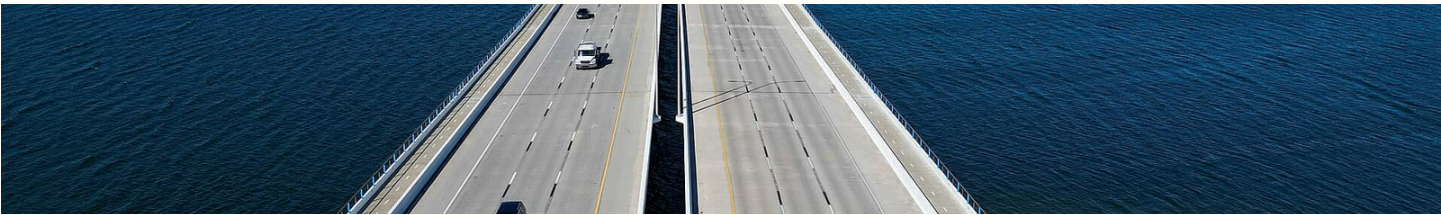
The official 2026 BAH area is FL056, EGLIN AFB, FL. Use the duty ZIP and finance determination; do not substitute a home ZIP or a mislabeled rate table.

Office contacts are checked for this edition, but staffing, hours, gate access, availability and instructions can change. Use the linked official source and your sponsor before travel. This independent real estate guide does not replace orders, command instructions or government counseling.

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [Military OneSource: Eglin AFB installation overview](#) · [U.S. Air Force: Eglin housing](#) · [DTMO: Official BAH rates and downloads](#)

02 A workable PCS calendar

This is a planning sequence, not a command deadline or guaranteed closing schedule.



Illustrative countdown

Timing / Focus

01 90 or more days out Confirm assignment, sponsor, finance/transportation counseling and household needs	02 60 days out Compare housing paths, apply for eligible housing, arrange lodging and lender preapproval if buying	03 30 days out Confirm shipment, inspections/contract dates, schools, insurance and document packet
04 7 days out Reconfirm arrival instructions, lodging, cash access, travel documents and contacts	05 Arrival week Report as directed, coordinate housing check-in and shipment delivery, document condition	06 First month Complete finance follow-up, household setup, records and any purchase obligations

If orders arrive late, compress the research sequence rather than skipping critical approvals. A temporary housing plan can preserve the ability to

inspect and compare properties. Do not make a nonrefundable commitment solely because a projected report date appears likely.

YOUR WORKING NOTES · CONFIRM WITH THE RESPONSIBLE PROFESSIONAL

Your controlling dates

Report-no-later-than date / approved leave or travel:

Shipment pickup / delivery window / lodging:

Lease or purchase deadlines / backup housing:

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [Military OneSource: PCS and moving FAQs](#) · [Military OneSource: Relocation Assistance Program](#)

03

Choose the housing path first

Government guidance, a private lease and a purchase solve different problems.



Three options to compare

Option / Confirm before committing

Installation / privatized housing

Eligibility, waitlist, offered unit, lease, utilities, pets and move-in timing

Community rental

Total move-in cash, lease terms, military termination review, condition and commute

Purchase

Expected ownership horizon, preapproval, closing cash, full monthly cost and exit plan

Contact Eglin Military Housing Office at 850-882-4533, extension 3 about your situation. Ask whether student, unaccompanied, accompanied or duty-status rules affect the options. Availability is not

promised by this guide. Request the actual lease and have the proper office or legal assistance review questions about military termination provisions.

KEEP IN MIND

Short tour, uncertain assignment or unsettled budget

Consider the cost of flexibility. Buying creates transaction costs and maintenance exposure; renting can create deposits, lease obligations and renewal uncertainty. Compare both over the length of time you reasonably expect to stay.

YOUR WORKING NOTES · CONFIRM WITH THE RESPONSIBLE PROFESSIONAL

Your housing decision

Likely stay / uncertainty / required flexibility:

Waitlist or rental option / purchase fallback:

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [Military OneSource: Eglin AFB installation overview](#) · [U.S. Air Force: Eglin housing](#) · [Military OneSource: Relocation Assistance Program](#)

04

Compare places by your actual route

These are geographic search areas to investigate, not rankings of communities.



Starting areas for comparison

Area / Evidence to collect

Niceville and Valparaiso

Address-specific work route, housing options, total cost, parcel flood/insurance facts and district-confirmed school assignment

Shalimar and Fort Walton Beach

Address-specific work route, housing options, total cost, parcel flood/insurance facts and district-confirmed school assignment

Crestview and other north-county alternatives

Address-specific work route, housing options, total cost, parcel flood/insurance facts and district-confirmed school assignment

Confirm the authorized gate and work center before comparing homes. Test routes at the actual shift

Run a useful route test

- ☐ Use the exact gate and work building authorized for your assignment.
- ☐ Record normal time, a delayed trip, and a practical alternate route.
- ☐ Compare any tolls, fuel, parking or vehicle needs in the household budget.

time and include any bridge, toll or alternate-route implications relevant to the address.

- ☐ Check more than one weekday at the expected report and return times.
- ☐ Add childcare, school, second workplace and essential appointments.

KEEP IN MIND

Choose using your own priorities

Evaluate property features, accessibility, budget, services and route evidence. Community-wide labels cannot establish the suitability of an individual home or school. Verify school assignment directly for the exact address.

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [Military OneSource: Eglin AFB installation overview](#) · [U.S. Air Force: Eglin housing](#)

05

2026 BAH: enlisted grades

EGLIN AFB, FL · FL056 · monthly published rates

Official monthly rates

Pay grade	With dependents	Without dependents
E-1	\$2,340	\$2,007
E-2	\$2,340	\$2,007
E-3	\$2,340	\$2,007
E-4	\$2,340	\$2,007
E-5	\$2,433	\$2,157
E-6	\$2,526	\$2,250
E-7	\$2,841	\$2,340
E-8	\$3,189	\$2,457
E-9	\$3,447	\$2,586

Source: DTMO 2026 BAH all-locations ASCII download. E-1 through E-9 shown. Amounts are the published rate schedule, not a determination of an individual entitlement.

BAH generally reflects the permanent duty location, pay grade and dependency status under applicable rules. The number of dependents does not create a separate rate for each child. Your finance office

confirms the applicable duty ZIP, status, effective date, rate protection, dual-military circumstances and any exception.

KEEP IN MIND

Your home ZIP is not a shortcut

This guide uses 32542 to identify the installation planning area. Living in a different ZIP does not by itself change the duty-location rate. Verify your orders with finance before committing to a payment.

YOUR WORKING NOTES · CONFIRM WITH THE RESPONSIBLE PROFESSIONAL

Your finance confirmation

Pay grade / dependency status / effective date:

Confirmed BAH / other applicable allowance:

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [DTMO: Official BAH rates and downloads](#)

06

2026 BAH: officer and warrant grades

EGLIN AFB, FL · FL056 · monthly published rates

Official monthly rates

Pay grade	With dependents	Without dependents
W-1	\$2,544	\$2,322
W-2	\$2,985	\$2,454
W-3	\$3,414	\$2,589
W-4	\$3,456	\$2,604
W-5	\$3,516	\$2,922
O-1E	\$2,910	\$2,430
O-2E	\$3,351	\$2,514
O-3E	\$3,468	\$2,601
O-1	\$2,451	\$2,244
O-2	\$2,523	\$2,406
O-3	\$3,399	\$2,592
O-4	\$3,528	\$2,865
O-5	\$3,612	\$3,066
O-6	\$3,642	\$3,393

Source: DTMO 2026 tables. O-E categories require the applicable prior-enlisted/warrant service eligibility; do not select them solely because the monthly amount is higher.

KEEP IN MIND

Use the official lookup for other grades

This page includes common officer and warrant grades through O-6. The original DTMO download and lookup provide the complete schedule. Finance determines eligibility, not this table.

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [DTMO: Official BAH rates and downloads](#)

07

Translate BAH into a housing budget

An allowance is one income input, not the same as a comfortable mortgage payment.



Hypothetical \$300,000 loan, 6.00%, 30 years

Monthly component	Illustration
Principal and interest	\$1,799
Buyer -based property tax	\$350
Homeowners / wind	\$275
Flood coverage	\$75
HOA	\$50
Total illustrated housing payment	\$2,549
E- 5 with -dependents published BAH	\$2,433
Housing cost minus that BAH	\$116

The selected interest rate, loan, taxes, insurance and HOA are hypothetical, not local quotes or market averages. A negative final difference means the illustrated payment is below that BAH amount. Add utilities, maintenance, emergency reserves and other household costs before deciding what is comfortable. Any financed VA funding fee would also change principal.

KEEP IN MIND

Price and payment are not interchangeable

Ask the lender for an actual Loan Estimate and the county/insurer for address-specific costs. A seller’s current tax bill may understate the buyer’s later bill after reassessment.

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [DTMO: Official BAH rates and downloads](#) · [Florida DOR: Save Our Homes and portability](#) · [VA: Funding fee and closing costs](#)

o8

Cash for the move and for the home

Keep reimbursements, closing funds and reserves separate.



Hypothetical cash-flow plan

Item	Example planning amount
Temporary lodging paid before reimbursement	\$2,400
Travel, meals and fuel paid initially	\$900
Deposits / utility setup	\$650
Storage or delivery contingency	\$600
Initial move cash example	\$4,550
Separate purchase cash / repair reserve	Use lender estimate and inspection -based plan

Amounts are invented planning placeholders, not authorized reimbursement rates. A cost being necessary does not automatically make it reimbursable.

DTMO increased the standard maximum TLE period to 21 days for a move to a CONUS permanent duty station, effective November 27, 2024. TLE is partial reimbursement subject to the governing rules, eligible days, documentation and finance determination; it is not a promise that every hotel expense will be paid.

Ask about your itinerary and any special authorization.

KEEP IN MIND

Do not spend expected reimbursement twice

Maintain enough liquidity for charges due before a voucher is paid. Keep itemized receipts and ask finance about lodging, dependents, travel-card requirements and any advance before relying on them.

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [DTMO: CONUS Temporary Lodging Expense, 21 days](#) · [Military OneSource: Temporary Lodging Expense](#) · [Military OneSource: PCS and moving FAQs](#)

09

Household goods and travel records

A documented move is easier to reconcile and resolve.



Before pickup

- ☐ Complete transportation counseling and confirm the shipment method, authorized limits and current procedures.
- ☐ Photograph valuable items, record serial numbers, and retain important records outside the shipment.
- ☐ Keep medications, essential equipment, identity documents, orders, closing records and a travel kit with you.
- ☐ Confirm pickup access, parking, inventory procedures, storage needs and delivery contact details.
- ☐ Ask the transportation office how to report missed dates, loss, damage or other service issues under current rules.

At pickup and delivery, review inventories and note exceptions promptly. Save the documents and photographs in an organized file. If an item is missing or damaged, use the current official

loss/damage notification and claim process; its deadlines may differ, so do not wait for a future article or assume an old deadline still applies.

YOUR WORKING NOTES · CONFIRM WITH THE RESPONSIBLE PROFESSIONAL

Shipment and travel file

Transportation office / shipment reference:

Carrier / pickup / required delivery / actual delivery:

Inventory exceptions / notification deadline / claim status:

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [Military OneSource: PCS and moving FAQs](#)

10

Schools, healthcare and household continuity

Verify enrollment and services directly before choosing an address.



For Eglin AFB, begin with the installation relocation office and school liaison, then the district serving the exact property. Okaloosa County is the installation county; a home across a county boundary may be served by a different district. A real estate portal's school label does not establish current assignment, transportation, capacity or program eligibility.

Transfer checklist

- ☐ Ask the school district about enrollment records, address verification, placement, transportation and registration timing.
- ☐ Coordinate individual learning-support records and required meetings through the school professionals.
- ☐ Use the appropriate military healthcare channels to plan enrollment, referrals, prescriptions and continuity of care.
- ☐ If applicable, coordinate EFMP and accessibility needs through the authorized offices before finalizing housing.
- ☐ Ask about childcare availability and enrollment; do not assume a place is reserved because a center exists.
- ☐ Plan spouse employment, vehicle/identity records, pets, utilities and emergency contacts.

KEEP IN MIND

Keep sensitive records in the right channel

Send medical, education, identity and financial records through the responsible organization's secure process. Your housing search does not require posting those records in a shared listing conversation.

YOUR WORKING NOTES · CONFIRM WITH THE RESPONSIBLE PROFESSIONAL

Household continuity plan

School liaison / district confirmation / childcare status:

Healthcare transfer / appointment / records owner:

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [Military OneSource: Relocation Assistance Program](#)

11

Coastal condition and storm planning

Price the property's exposure before you sign.



Obtain property-specific homeowners/wind and flood quotes during the contract review period. Ask about roof condition, inspection requirements, exclusions, replacement-cost assumptions,

deductibles and binding timing. Standard homeowners coverage generally excludes flood. A lender's flood requirement and your own risk decision are separate questions.

Illustrative storm reserve

Example	Cash implication
Dwelling coverage \$400,000 with 2% deductible	\$8,000 deductible exposure
Same coverage with 5% deductible	\$20,000 deductible exposure
Difference to plan for	\$12,000

Read the actual policy for triggers and calculation basis. These examples are not a quote or recommendation of a deductible.

Arrival preparation

- ☐ Locate official county and installation emergency information.
- ☐ Identify supplies, documents, transportation and an out-of-area contact.
- ☐ Review evacuation and shelter options for your household, pets and accessibility needs.
- ☐ Photograph the home's move-in condition and retain policy details offline.

KEEP IN MIND

Choose based on the parcel

Flood zone, drainage, elevation, building condition and coverage can vary within a community. Obtain the applicable records and professional review for the exact property.

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [Florida OIR: Homeowners insurance](#) · [Florida CFO: Hurricane deductibles](#) · [NFIP: Buying flood insurance and waiting periods](#)

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Arrival and the next PCS

Close the move and retain a practical exit option.

First-week priorities

Action / Confirmation

Report and in-process Gaining unit instructions completed	Housing check-in Lease/deed, condition record, keys and utilities
Shipment delivery Inventory and exceptions documented	Finance follow-up Voucher, receipts, allowance changes and questions
Household services School, childcare, healthcare and emergency plan	Homeownership tasks First mortgage payment, insurance and tax-exemption calendar

Before buying, compare what selling or renting the property could require if the next assignment arrives early. Use conservative resale, vacancy, management, repairs and carrying-cost

assumptions. Confirm any association, lease, lending or insurance restrictions on rental use. If considering a VA assumption as a seller, separately address liability release and entitlement.

YOUR WORKING NOTES · CONFIRM WITH THE RESPONSIBLE PROFESSIONAL

Your first-month review

Unpaid or unresolved move expense / owner / deadline:

Home documents / insurance / first payment confirmed:

Exit strategy / reserve target / review date:

KEEP IN MIND

Bring the remaining questions to your team

Gregg coordinates the property search and transaction. Your command, housing office, transportation office, finance office, lender and other professionals confirm decisions within their roles.

Sources reviewed 2026-09-06: [Military OneSource: PCS and moving FAQs](#) · [VA: Assumption entitlement acknowledgment, Form 26-10291](#) · [Florida DOR: Save Our Homes and portability](#)

FOLLOW THE EVIDENCE

The original guidance.

Consult the source before relying on a changing amount, deadline, policy or contact. Source review: 2026-09-06.

01

Military OneSource: Eglin AFB installation overview

<https://installations.militaryonesource.mil/in-depth-overview/eglin-afb>

02

U.S. Air Force: Eglin housing

<https://www.housing.af.mil/Home-depricated/Units/Eglin/>

03

DTMO: Official BAH rates and downloads

<https://www.travel.dod.mil/Allowances/Basic-Allowance-for-Housing/BAH-Rate-Lookup/>

04

Military OneSource: PCS and moving FAQs

<https://www.militaryonesource.mil/moving-pcs/plan-to-move/military-pcs-moving-faqs/>

05

Military OneSource: Relocation Assistance Program

<https://www.militaryonesource.mil/benefits/relocation-assistance-program/>

06

Florida DOR: Save Our Homes and portability

<https://floridarevenue.com/property/Documents/pt112.pdf>

Apply the rule to your situation

This is an educational resource. Your lender, closing professional, insurer, property appraiser and installation offices confirm matters within their roles. No government agency, military installation or lender sponsors or endorses this publication. Source review dates change only after actual verification.

The appearance of U.S. Department of War (DoW) visual information does not imply or constitute DoW endorsement.

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07**VA: Funding fee and closing costs**

<https://www.va.gov/housing-assistance/home-loans/funding-fee-and-closing-costs/>

08**DTMO: CONUS Temporary Lodging Expense, 21 days**

<https://www.travel.dod.mil/About/News/Article/Article/3981433/dod-authorizes-additional-7-days-to-conus-temporary-lodging-expense/>

09**Military OneSource: Temporary Lodging Expense**

<https://www.militaryonesource.mil/benefits/temporary-lodging-expense/>

10**Florida OIR: Homeowners insurance**

<https://floir.gov/property-casualty/homeowners-insurance>

11**Florida CFO: Hurricane deductibles**

<https://www.myfloridacfo.com/division/consumers/consumerprotections/floridashurricaneductible>

12**NFIP: Buying flood insurance and waiting periods**

<https://www.floodsmart.gov/get-insured/buy-a-policy>

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13**VA: Assumption entitlement acknowledgment, Form 26-10291**

<https://www.vba.va.gov/pubs/forms/VBA-26-10291-ARE.pdf>

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THE COSTIN TEAM · LEVIN RINKE REALTY

Gregg Costin

REALTOR® · Licensed in Florida & Alabama

Coastal expertise. Personal attention.

From waterfront homes and first purchases to complex military moves, I bring disciplined planning, clear advice and skilled negotiation to one of your most consequential decisions.

RECOGNITION

2025 Rookie of the Year

Levin Rinke Realty / Forbes Global Properties

Retired U.S. Air Force Captain · E-3 AWACS Combat Systems Officer · Prior-enlisted Staff Sergeant

20 years of military service. 11 personal PCS moves.

\$25M+

Transaction volume

60+

Families helped
in the past year

99.89%

List-to-price ratio
Seller clients

8.1%

Average price reduction
Buyer clients

Credentials behind the guidance.

ABR® Accredited Buyer's Representative

RENE® Real Estate Negotiation Expert

MRP® Military Relocation Professional

MCA® MORE Certified Agent

SRS® Seller Representative Specialist

HFR® Home Finance Resource

FMS® Florida Military Specialist

FAA Part 107 Certified

Let's plan your next move.

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Performance figures provided by Gregg Costin, September 6, 2026.

Credentials & recognition: [Brokerage profile](#) · [Biography](#) · Reviewed September 6, 2026. [All contact links](#).

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